

Photographs by ANI

OPPOSING NARRATIVES
Far Left, Andhra Pradesh CM Y.S. Jaganmohan Reddy campaigning in Palamaneru, Chittoor, May 5; TDP chief N. Chandrababu Naidu with PM Narendra Modi at a rally in Anakapalle, May 6

seats and 175 legislative assembly seats slated for May13, the battle lines are drawn between YSRCP and the opposition National Democratic Alliance (NDA), comprising arch-rival TDP led by N. Chandrababu Naidu as well as the BJP and actor Pawan Kalyan's Jana Sena Party (JSP). No-holds-barred attacks are the norm in this double-barreled contest for political control of the state.

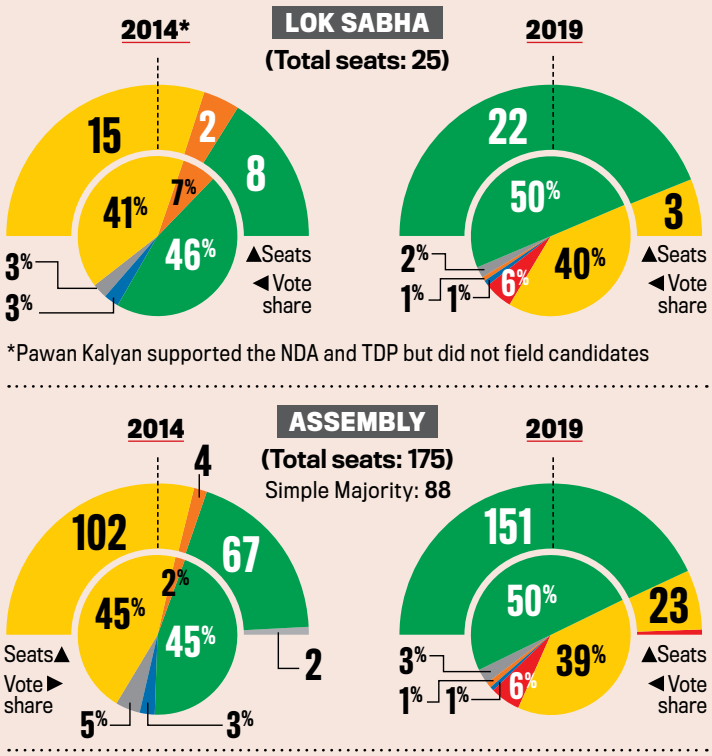
The previous evening, at a rally in Nellore, the TDP supremo had raised the pitch of the attack, terming Jagan Reddy a "destructor and dacoit", and confidently predicting a rout for the YSRCP in the elections and a sweep for the NDA troika. "These elections are a fight between *dharma* and *adharma*, between destruction and development, a battle between the dacoit that Jagan is and five crore people of the state," Naidu thundered.

The CM is looking for a second successive term, hoping that—with 38 state welfare schemes costing Rs 4.2 lakh crore reaching 125 million beneficiaries—around half the electorate will renew its support for him. Naidu has declared that at 74, this will be his last election and has made the emotional plea that he wants one last chance to set right the state that has been, he alleges, driven away from the path of development.

In addition to the bitter struggle between the YSRCP and the TDP, there is the combine of the Congress—led by Jagan's sister Y.S. Sharmila—and the Communist Party of India (Marxist), CPI, and a faction of the CPI (Marxist Leninist) in the mix. They, too, have been taking potshots at Jagan, recently accusing him of frittering away state resources, and leading a corrupt and chaotic administration. By contesting from the family pocket borough of Kadapa

TURNING TABLES

Between 2014 and 2019, roles were reversed between the TDP and the YSRCP



Vote share figures have been rounded off